

Persuasive Speech Evaluation

Your task is to review your speech and to reach a full, objective assessment of its major strengths and weaknesses. Please answer the following questions in 2-4 complete sentences each. Be specific and concrete in your comments. Explain why you had difficulty with certain aspects of this speech and indicate the specific steps you will take to improve your next presentation.

1. Evaluate the effectiveness of your organization. *Name one strength and one weakness of your organization with time stamps as examples.* Questions to think about: Did you grab attention and clearly state your main points in the thesis? Were the main points of the body clear and easy to follow? Did you memorably close? Did you use your organizational pattern well?

One major strength of my organization was the clear preview of the three main points provided between [01:41] and [01:49], which established a logical roadmap for the audience to follow. A weakness, however, was that my introduction was quite long, taking until [01:23] to reach the actual thesis statement, which may have delayed the audience's understanding or delayed their interest. I had difficulty with this because I wanted to include multiple student testimonies to build relatability, clarify the issue's relevance, and establish my credibility. However, in the future, I will condense the introductory section of my speeches, sharing only what is critical for the audience's understanding.

2. Evaluate the effectiveness of your content. *Name one strength and one weakness of your content with time stamps as examples.* Questions to think about: Was your purpose clear? Interesting? Did you support your points with evidence and examples? Did you appeal to logos, ethos, and pathos? Which was most effective? Did you address counterarguments?

A significant strength of my content was the effective use of ethos and logos, specifically when I cited my academic background as a neuroscience major at [01:09]. A weakness was the lack of a clear counterargument stance; while I briefly mentioned at [06:40] that willpower alone is insufficient, I did not deeply address the perspective of those who believe personal responsibility is the only solution. To improve, I will integrate a dedicated section for opposing views to make my persuasive stance more comprehensive.

3. Evaluate the effectiveness of your delivery. *Name one strength and one area of improvement with time stamps as examples.* Questions to think about: Did you rush? How effective were your pauses, rate, pitch, and vocal variety? Did you feel that your gestures and movement enhanced or distracted from your message? Did you maintain strong eye contact throughout the speech?

One strength of my delivery was the use of transition questions to guide the audience through complex topics, such as asking, "So how do we put an end to it?" at [05:50]. An area for improvement is my reliance on verbal fillers like "And so" at [03:07] and [06:27], which can detract from a professional tone. I struggled with this while explaining the neurobiological diagrams, so next time I will practice explaining those more, and I will use silent pauses instead of vocal fillers when transitioning between visual aids.

4. What are you most proud of in your speech? If you had an opportunity to deliver this speech again next week, what changes would you make? Be specific.

I am most proud of the closing analogy I used at [07:56], where I compared modern smartphones to casinos built without windows or clocks to trap users. I think this was a creative close, which took the complex topic and left them with one simple powerful analogy for it all. If I were to deliver this speech again, I would simplify the technical jargon surrounding the "mesolimbic reward pathways" to ensure the audience remains engaged with the broader message. Additionally, I would provide a specific contact method for the local congressman mentioned at [08:21] to make the final "call to action" more concrete, so as to make it easier for listeners to actually take action!